

Physician: Dr. Ramesh Kumar MD

NPI Number: 1234567890

Date: March 16, 2026

RE: PRIOR AUTHORIZATION REQUEST FOR CARDIAC MRI WITH CONTRAST (CPT 75563)

PATIENT HISTORY

The patient is a 58-year-old male with a documented 3-year history of Dilated Cardiomyopathy (ICD-10: I42.0). Initially diagnosed in January 2023 following a presentation with acute dyspnea, the patient has since exhibited a chronic and progressive clinical course. Current presentation is significant for worsening shortness of breath on exertion, persistent fatigue, and a marked reduction in exercise tolerance that interferes with activities of daily living. Furthermore, the patient reports occasional palpitations, necessitating advanced diagnostic evaluation to assess for structural triggers or arrhythmogenic substrates.

CURRENT SYMPTOMS

At present, the patient exhibits symptoms consistent with New York Heart Association (NYHA) Class III heart failure. Clinical findings include shortness of breath both at rest and upon minimal physical exertion, as well as significant orthopnea requiring 3-pillow support for sleep. Physical examination reveals bilateral lower extremity edema, indicating volume overload. Recent diagnostic monitoring confirms a persistently reduced ejection fraction, signifying a lack of improvement despite standard therapeutic interventions.

PREVIOUS TREATMENTS TRIED

The patient has remained strictly compliant with Guideline-Directed Medical Therapy (GDMT) since diagnosis. The therapeutic regimen includes the following:

- Carvedilol: 25mg twice daily (initiated January 2023)
- Lisinopril: 10mg daily (initiated January 2023)
- Spironolactone: 25mg daily (initiated March 2023)
- Furosemide: 40mg daily for fluid management

Despite adherence to optimal medical therapy for over three years, the patient's symptoms persist and have shown recent signs of progression, suggesting the underlying pathology requires more granular characterization than what is provided by current management tools.

CLINICAL INSUFFICIENCY OF ECHOCARDIOGRAPHY

A transthoracic echocardiogram (TTE) performed in January 2026 documented a Left Ventricular Ejection Fraction (LVEF) of 35% with global hypokinesis. While the TTE provided a baseline assessment of chamber size and function, it is insufficient to fully characterize the myocardial tissue or identify specific fibrosis patterns. Standard echocardiography lacks the resolution required to assess myocardial viability or definitively rule out infiltrative cardiomyopathies. Consequently, a Cardiac MRI with contrast is essential for

definitive tissue characterization and to provide the high-resolution data necessary to guide future high-stakes treatment decisions.

MEDICAL NECESSITY STATEMENT

Cardiac MRI with contrast is medically necessary for this patient to evaluate myocardial fibrosis via Late Gadolinium Enhancement (LGE). This study is critical to assess myocardial viability for potential revascularization candidacy and to differentiate between ischemic and non-ischemic cardiomyopathy. The findings from this advanced imaging will directly impact the clinical treatment plan, influence prognosis, and determine the appropriateness of further interventional therapies.

Respectfully,

Dr. Ramesh Kumar MD
Date Signed: March 16, 2026
Credentials: Board Certified Cardiologist
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